THE TATTOO ARTIST COLLECTION

Tattoo Forms, Protocols & Aftercare

Written by a licensed esthetician. Every page edits in a free Canva account, in US Letter and A4.

What's inside

CLIENT FORMS

Client intake & health history (2 pages)
Design consultation & placement map
Tattoo consent
Ink & skin sensitivity record
Photo & portfolio release
Booking & deposit policy
Session record with ink lot log

STUDIO TOOLS

Pre-appointment prep sheet
Healing guide for clients
Artist cheat sheet: needles, wraps & ink
Contraindication chart
Reaction & incident report
Sanitation & autoclave log
Take-home aftercare cards (4 × 6 in)

SERVICE SETS: CONSENT · PROTOCOL · AFTERCARE · CARD

Standard tattoo
Custom or flash, single session

Cover-up & rework
Covering or reworking old tattoos

Fine line & micro
Single-needle & delicate work

Color, realism & large-scale
Sleeves & multi-session pieces

Touch-up
Refreshing a fully healed tattoo

Second-skin healing
Adhesive film wrap & aftercare

How to make them yours

1
In a free Canva account, click Create, then Upload, and choose this PDF.

2
Canva turns every page into an editable design.

3
Add your logo, business name and colors.

4
Download as PDF to print, or fill in on a tablet.

BEFORE YOU USE THESE

These templates are a starting point, not legal or medical advice. Tattoo laws, minimum ages and infection-control rules vary by state, county and country, so check your state and local health department rules. Use inks that are legal where you work (REACH-compliant in the EU and UK) and have a local attorney review your consent forms.

Rather go paperless?

Send, sign and store every one of these forms from your phone with SlickChart.

slickchart.app

Created by Ashley Watson, licensed esthetician

For use by the purchaser's own business. Not for resale.

Tattoo Client Intake

YOUR LOGO

About you

FULL NAME

BIRTH DATE

MOBILE PHONE

EMAIL

ADDRESS

EMERGENCY CONTACT & RELATIONSHIP

THEIR PHONE

HOW DID YOU HEAR ABOUT US?

BEST WAY TO REACH YOU ☐ Text ☐ Email ☐ Call

OK TO TEXT YOU REMINDERS? ☐ Yes ☐ No

AGE & ID CHECK 18+ only. Bring valid government photo ID to every appointment. We keep a copy on file.

ID type ☐ Driver's license ☐ State ID ☐ Passport ID # (last 4) _____ Expires _____

Artist: ☐ 18 or older, ID verified ☐ Photo matches client ☐ Copy kept on file Initials _____

Your tattoo

WHICH SERVICE ARE YOU BOOKING?

☐ Standard tattoo ☐ Cover-up or rework ☐ Fine line or micro ☐ Large-scale or sleeve

☐ Color or realism ☐ Touch-up ☐ Flash or walk-in ☐ Not sure yet

YOUR IDEA, IN A FEW WORDS

WHERE ON YOUR BODY?

SIZE (INCHES)

FIRST TATTOO? ☐ Yes ☐ No

INK ☐ Black & gray ☐ Color ☐ Both ☐ Not sure

Your tattoo & skin history

Past tattoos and how they healed help us plan your design, placement and aftercare.

	Yes	No	Notes
Healed well from past tattoos	☐	☐	
A tattoo that stayed raised or itchy	☐	☐	
Keloid or raised scar anywhere	☐	☐	
Laser removal or fading	☐	☐	
Fainted with needles or blood	☐	☐	

	Yes	No	Notes
Reaction to tattoo ink, any color	☐	☐	
Reaction to bandage or tape	☐	☐	
Healed with second-skin film	☐	☐	
Used numbing cream before	☐	☐	
Sunburn or tan at the site now	☐	☐	

ALCOHOL OR DRUGS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS? ☐ No ☐ Yes

EATEN IN THE LAST 3 HOURS? ☐ Yes ☐ No

YOUR JOB, SPORTS OR HOBBIES (SUN, WATER AND FRICTION AFFECT HEALING)

Health, Allergies & Agreement

CLIENT NAME _____

Allergies & sensitivities

ARE YOU ALLERGIC OR SENSITIVE TO ANY OF THESE? CHECK ALL THAT APPLY

- ☐ Latex
- ☐ Bandage or tape adhesive
- ☐ Tattoo ink (red is most common)
- ☐ Soaps or antiseptics
- ☐ Ointments or lotions
- ☐ Fragrance
- ☐ Lidocaine or numbing creams
- ☐ Nickel or other metals
- ☐ None that I know of

REACTION YOU HAD, AND TO WHAT _____

Your health

Please answer every line. Some answers mean we wait or need your doctor's OK. Never stop a medicine on your own.

	Yes	No
Pregnant or breastfeeding	☐	☐
Blood thinners or daily aspirin	☐	☐
Bleeding or clotting disorder	☐	☐
Diabetes	☐	☐
Immune suppression or chemo	☐	☐
Heart condition or pacemaker	☐	☐
Epilepsy or seizures	☐	☐

	Yes	No
Fainting or low blood pressure	☐	☐
Eczema, psoriasis or rash at the site	☐	☐
Accutane (isotretinoin) in the last [6–12] months	☐	☐
Moles or birthmarks at the site	☐	☐
Skin cancer, now or in the past	☐	☐
Hepatitis or a bloodborne condition (optional)	☐	☐
Any other medical condition	☐	☐

ALL MEDICATIONS YOU TAKE, INCLUDING PRESCRIPTIONS AND SUPPLEMENTS

_____

NUMBING PRODUCT USED TODAY OR PLANNED? ☐ No ☐ Yes: product & strength _____

Numbing: [studio policy]. Never use more than 4% lidocaine, and apply only as directed to a small area.

Agreement

	Initials
My answers are true and complete. I'll tell my artist if my health or medicines change.	
I am 18 or older and have shown valid photo ID. I have had no alcohol or drugs in the last 24 hours.	
Ink allergies can appear years later. Tattoos can rarely tingle during an MRI, so I'll tell my radiologist.	
No exact result is promised. I'll follow my aftercare and see a doctor if I notice signs of infection.	
I'll tell the studio about any reaction so it can be recorded with the ink brand and lot number.	

Your privacy: your information is kept confidential, stored securely and used only to provide your services. Records and a copy of your ID are kept [3] years or as your state requires.

CLIENT SIGNATURE _____ PRINTED NAME _____ DATE _____

ARTIST USE Skin at site checked ☐ Yes Concerns ☐ None ☐ Noted _____

Doctor's OK needed? ☐ Yes ☐ No On file? ☐ Yes ☐ No Artist _____

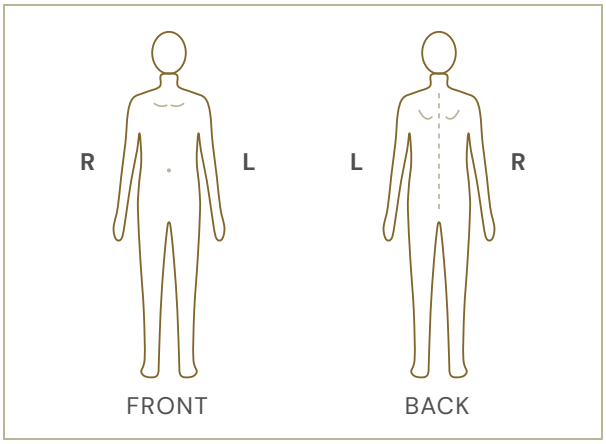
CONSULTATION · ARTIST & CLIENT SIGN-OFF

Design Consultation & Placement

YOUR LOGO

CLIENT NAME | DATE | ARTIST

Placement



BODY AREA

WIDTH (IN) | HEIGHT (IN) | WRAPS AROUND?

CHECKED ☐ Standing ☐ Seated ☐ Mirror

SKIN ☐ Clear ☐ Moles ☐ Scars ☐ Old tattoo

WORK AROUND (MOLES, SCARS, EXISTING WORK)

Mark the spot and size. We work around moles, never over.

Style & references

☐ Fine line ☐ Traditional ☐ Neo-traditional ☐ Black & gray realism

☐ Color realism ☐ Blackwork ☐ Script or lettering ☐ Japanese

☐ Geometric or dotwork ☐ Watercolor ☐ Illustrative ☐ Other:

INK ☐ Black & gray ☐ Color ☐ Both DESIGN ☐ Custom ☐ Flash #

REFERENCES (INSPIRATION ONLY: YOUR ARTIST DRAWS AN ORIGINAL DESIGN)

Lettering & spelling check

WORDS, NAMES OR DATES, EXACTLY AS THEY SHOULD APPEAR (PRINT CLEARLY)

CLIENT INITIALS

I checked the spelling, accents, numbers and dates above, and I'll check them again on the stencil.

Quote & session plan

QUOTE OR HOURLY RATE | DEPOSIT PAID | DESIGN FEE

ESTIMATED SESSIONS | HOURS PER SESSION | HEAL BETWEEN: [3–4] WEEKS

Client approval: I reviewed the placement, size and design plan with my artist. I'll approve the final design and stencil before we start. The quote is an estimate and may change if the size or detail changes.

☐ Intake & health form reviewed ☐ Deposit received ☐ References saved ☐ Before photos taken

CLIENT SIGNATURE | ARTIST SIGNATURE | DATE

INFORMED CONSENT & RELEASE · STUDIO

Tattoo Consent & Release

CLIENT NAME

BIRTH DATE | DATE | TATTOO DESIGN & PLACEMENT

WHAT THIS COVERS
Custom, flash, fine line, cover-up, large-scale and touch-up work at [Your Business Name].

HOW IT'S DONE
Single-use needles and ink caps, and barrier film on equipment, per [County] health department rules.

PERMANENCE
Tattoos are permanent. Laser removal is costly, slow and may not be complete.

Possible risks

Infection. Redness, heat, swelling or pus, most often from aftercare problems.

Allergic reaction. To ink pigments, red most often. Can appear months or years later.

Scarring and keloids. Raised or thick scars, more likely if you have scarred before.

Blowout. Ink spreading under the skin into a blurry halo. It can't be undone.

Bleeding and bruising. More likely with blood thinners, alcohol or a lot of caffeine.

Fading and touch-ups. Healing varies, and patchy spots may need a touch-up.

Granulomas. Small bumps around ink particles, sometimes long after healing.

MRI effects. Rare tingling or burning. Tell your radiologist about your tattoos.

Fainting. Eat a meal and drink water first. Tell your artist if you feel unwell.

Skin flare-ups. Eczema, psoriasis or sun sensitivity can flare in tattooed skin.

Results depend on your skin, placement and aftercare. Pregnant, on blood thinners or Accutane? Tell your artist first.

Ink brand, color and lot # are logged for recalls. Report US ink reactions to the FDA (MedWatch).

Please initial each statement

	Initials
I've read the risks above and had my questions answered. No result was promised.	
My health information is true and complete, including medications and any numbing product I used.	
I approved the final design, size and placement before the stencil, and checked all spelling.	
I understand my tattoo is permanent, and that aging, sun and my skin can change how it looks.	
No tattooing over moles, rashes, sunburn or broken skin. My session may be changed or rescheduled.	
I'll follow aftercare and contact you, and a doctor, if signs of infection or a reaction appear.	
I [do / do not] agree to photos of my tattoo for my records and portfolio, with no face shown.	
I release [Your Business Name] from claims from details I withheld or aftercare I skipped, per [State] law.	
I am 18 or older with valid photo ID, not under the influence of alcohol or drugs, and signing freely.	

CLIENT SIGNATURE | PRINTED NAME | DATE | ARTIST · LICENSE #

PHOTO ID TYPE (COPY ON FILE) | ID NUMBER (LAST 4) | ID EXPIRY

CLIENT RECORD · SENSITIVITY HISTORY

Ink & Skin Sensitivity Record

YOUR LOGO

CLIENT NAME | PHONE | DATE STARTED

KNOWN ALLERGIES | DOCTOR · CLINIC

WHY INK SENSITIVITY MATTERS

Red ink is most often linked to allergic reactions, which can appear years later. Latex, adhesive, soaps and ointments can irritate skin too. **Artists don't diagnose allergies:** refer any itchy, raised or swollen area to a doctor.

Screening questions

Question			Details: what, when, what happened
Ever reacted to a tattoo or a specific ink color?	☐ Yes	☐ No	
Itching, bumps or swelling in a healed tattoo?	☐ Yes	☐ No	
Reacted to latex, bandage tape or second-skin film?	☐ Yes	☐ No	
Reacted to soaps, ointments, antiseptics or black henna?	☐ Yes	☐ No	

Ink lot log

Date	Ink brand · color	Lot #	Expiry	Placement	Reaction?	Initials

Reaction record

DATE NOTICED | SESSION DATE · INK COLOR · LOT #

SYMPTOMS ☐ Itching ☐ Raised bumps ☐ Swelling ☐ Rash or hives ☐ Blisters ☐ Worse in sun

WHERE ☐ One color only ☐ Whole tattoo ☐ Skin around it ☐ Elsewhere _____

ACTION TAKEN ☐ Referred to a doctor ☐ Ink maker notified ☐ FDA MedWatch report ☐ Photos on file

Plan going forward

☐ Avoid this ink color · brand · lot

☐ Doctor note on file before the next session

☐ Nitrile gloves only; no adhesive film

☐ Cleared to proceed; note on file

No ink is allergy-proof, whatever the label, so never promise a reaction-free tattoo. EU/UK: REACH-compliant inks.

I've shared my allergy history honestly. I'll report any itching, bumps or swelling in my tattoo, and call 911 for trouble breathing.

CLIENT SIGNATURE | DATE | ARTIST INITIALS

TATTOO STUDIO · YOUR CHOICE, EVERY TIME

Photo & Portfolio Release

YOUR LOGO

CLIENT NAME | PHONE OR EMAIL | DATE

Sharing photos is your choice. Saying no never affects your appointment, and you can change your mind any time.

Your choices

		Yes	No
1	**Studio record** Before and finished photos in my private file to track healing and touch-ups. Never shared.	REQUIRED	
2	**Portfolio** Shown on your website, in print, in a portfolio book or at a convention booth to show your work.	☐	☐
3	**Social media** Posted on your business social accounts, including process videos, time-lapses and reels.	☐	☐
4	**How much of me may be shown** If yes to 2 or 3, choose one. You may see any image before it's posted.	☐ Tattoo only, no identifying marks ☐ Tattoo & surrounding body ☐ My face may show	
5	**Tag me, name me or quote me** You may tag my social handle, use my first name, or quote my review with my photos.	☐	☐

NAME OR HANDLE TO USE (IF 5 IS YES) | LIMITS (AREAS, PLATFORMS, DATES)

Your face is never shown without your written OK. [Custom designs are never repeated for other clients.]

How your photos are handled

STORAGE
Kept on a studio device in [your secure app], never a personal camera roll, for [3] years or per state rules.

CHANGING YOUR MIND
Text or email to withdraw. Studio posts come down within [7] days; others' shares may be out of reach.

NO PAYMENT
This release is voluntary. You won't receive payment, royalties or free tattoos for photos or reviews.

HONEST IMAGES
No filters that change the color or crispness of your tattoo. Fresh and healed photos are labeled as such.

By signing, I confirm my choices above. This release stays in effect until I change or withdraw it in writing.

CLIENT SIGNATURE | DATE

WITHDRAWN Date received _____ Posts removed _____ Initials _____

DEPOSIT · BOOKING · TOUCH-UPS · CANCELLATION

Booking & Deposit Policy

YOUR LOGO

Your time and your custom design are reserved just for you. These policies keep things fair for everyone.

DEPOSIT
[$100] or [30]%
Non-refundable. Holds your date and design time; applied to your final session.

NOTICE TO CHANGE
[48] hours
To move your appointment and keep your deposit.

GRACE PERIOD
[15] minutes
After that, it counts as a no-show.

ID & age	18+ only. Bring valid government photo ID to every appointment. No ID, no tattoo, and your deposit is forfeited.
Design & design fee	Your deposit covers drawing time and [2] rounds of changes. Extra revisions or large custom pieces are [$__ per hour].
Rescheduling	[48] hours' notice moves your deposit [once]. After that, a new deposit is needed.
No-show & late	Arriving more than [15] minutes late without contact, or changing with less notice, counts as a no-show. Your deposit is forfeited.
Final approval	You approve the final design, size and stencil placement before we start. Names, dates and spelling are checked and initialed by you.
Drugs & alcohol	Please arrive sober, with no alcohol or drugs for 24 hours. We won't tattoo anyone who seems impaired, and the deposit is forfeited.
Guests	[One guest] welcome. No children or pets in the work area (health department rules).
Payment & tips	Balance due after each session [cash / card +3%]. Tips appreciated, never required.
Touch-ups	One free touch-up within [1–3] months, once fully healed (no sooner than [4–6] weeks). Hands, fingers, feet and face are [excluded]. Not covered: skipped aftercare or sun damage.
Refunds	No refunds once we start. Your artist may decline a design or adjust its size so it ages well.
Feeling unwell?	Sunburn, a rash or cuts at the site, or a fever? Tell us and we'll reschedule [with no fee].

CARD ON FILE FOR DEPOSITS AND FEES, CHARGED ONLY AS DESCRIBED ABOVE

☐ Card saved in [booking system] ☐ I prefer to prepay Never write card numbers on this form.

My deposit is non-refundable and will be applied to my final session. ☐

A tattoo is permanent. I'll check the spelling and placement before the stencil goes on. ☐

By signing, I confirm I've read and agree to this policy, including the non-refundable deposit and touch-up terms.

CLIENT SIGNATURE _____ DATE _____

PRINTED NAME _____ APPOINTMENT DATE _____

ARTIST RECORD · SHEET [__]

Tattoo Session Record

Log needles, ink brand, color, lot # and expiry at every session.

CLIENT NAME _____ BIRTH DATE _____ PHONE _____

SKIN NOTES · MOLES · SCARS _____ SENSITIVITY RECORD · DATE _____ ARTIST · LICENSE # _____

ALLERGIES & CAUTIONS _____

ALLERGIC TO ☐ Latex ☐ Adhesive film ☐ Ink color _____ ☐ Soaps, ointments ☐ Numbing products

Blood thinners, diabetes, keloids, Accutane, heart or seizure history, moles at site _____

ON FILE ☐ ID copy (18+) ☐ Intake ☐ Consent ☐ Sensitivity record ☐ Design sign-off ☐ Photo release

DATE	PLACEMENT · DESIGN	NEEDLES	INK BRAND · COLOR	LOT # · EXPIRY	MACHINE · VOLTS	NUMBING	TIME	DEPOSIT · PAID	INIT.

Note stencil and spelling sign-off, wrap used, and any blowout, heavy bleeding, fainting, reaction or referral.

Write in ink. Correct with a single line, then initial and date. Store securely for **[3] years** or as your state requires.

INFORMED CONSENT

Standard Tattoo Consent

YOUR LOGO

CLIENT NAME | BIRTH DATE | PHOTO ID TYPE · LAST 4 | DATE

WHAT IT IS
Ink placed in the skin with sterile, single-use needles for a custom or flash design in one session.

WHAT TO EXPECT
About [1–5] hours. Stinging or burning that varies by placement. Ask for a break any time.

HEALING AND PERMANENCE
The surface heals in about [2–4] weeks, deeper skin in [1–3] months. Your tattoo is permanent.

TODAY'S TATTOO ☐ Custom ☐ Flash ☐ Black & gray ☐ Color ☐ Plastic wrap ☐ Second-skin film

POSSIBLE RISKS AND SIDE EFFECTS

- Infection, most often from aftercare problems
- Raised scars or keloids, mainly in scar-prone skin
- Swelling, bruising or oozing for a few days
- A flare of eczema or psoriasis at the site
- Allergy to ink, even years later (red is most common)
- Blowout: ink spreading into a blurry halo
- Patchy or faded areas that may need a touch-up
- Rare burning or tingling during an MRI scan

Quick health check

- Pregnant or breastfeeding
- Immune suppression or chemo
- Keloid or raised scars
- Eczema or psoriasis
- Blood thinners or bleeding disorder
- Heart condition or pacemaker
- Accutane in last [6–12] months
- Allergy: latex, ink or ointment
- Diabetes
- Epilepsy or fainting
- Sunburn, rash or cut at the site
- Alcohol or drugs in last 24 hours

☐ **None of these apply to me** or list any that do: _____

Design sign-off. Placement: _____ Size: _____ in. I approved the final design and stencil placement, and checked every word, name, date and number. ☐ Design ☐ Spelling

Please initial each statement

	Initials
I've shared my full health and medication history, including any numbing product I applied today.	
My tattoo is permanent. Results depend on my skin, placement and aftercare, and aren't guaranteed.	
I saw new needles and cartridges opened for me and ink poured into single-use caps.	
I'll tell my artist right away if I feel faint, dizzy or unwell, or need a break.	
If I get spreading redness, pus, red streaks or a fever, I'll see a doctor and let the studio know.	
Ink brand, color and lot # are logged on my session record so I can be contacted if an ink is recalled.	
Before and after photos for my private record are OK. Social media use only with my separate release.	
Deposits and fees follow [Your Business Name] policy. No refunds once tattooing has started.	

By signing, I confirm I am 18 or older with valid photo ID (copy kept on file), am not under the influence of alcohol or drugs, have read this form, had my questions answered, and consent to this tattoo.

CLIENT SIGNATURE | DATE | ARTIST · LICENSE # | DATE

ARTIST PROTOCOL

Standard Tattoo

Custom or flash, single session. Times in [brackets] are guides. Check your state and local health department rules.

SCREEN

Intake and consent signed. Photo ID 18+ copied. Not intoxicated, pregnant or breastfeeding.

ALLERGY CHECK

Latex, adhesive, ink (red most common), soap, ointment. Numbing: max 4% lidocaine.

SKIN AT SITE

No sunburn, rash, cut or infection. Moles: work around, never over. Keloid history noted.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Barrier film on machine, cord, bottles, chair ☐ Nitrile gloves ☐ Sealed single-use cartridges ☐ Ink caps poured per client ☐ Sharps container in reach ☐ EPA disinfectant, full contact time ☐ Ink lot # noted

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & consent**	10 min	Review intake, ID and meds. Confirm design, placement, size and price.
2	**Set up station**	10 min	Disinfect surfaces, barrier film on. Open cartridges in front of the client.
3	**Skin prep**	5 min	Shave with a single-use razor, then antiseptic. Razor straight to sharps.
4	**Stencil & approval**	10 min	Client checks placement and spelling in a mirror, then initials.
5	**Lining**	[ ] min	Firm stretch, steady depth. Wipe with a fresh towel and green soap.
6	**Shading & color**	[ ] min	Shade, then pack color. Change gloves after touching anything off-tray.
7	**Wipe-down**	5 min	Gentle clean with a fresh towel. Check for holidays and blowout. Photos.
8	**Wrap**	5 min	Thin ointment, then plastic wrap or second-skin film as agreed.
9	**Aftercare review**	5 min	Review the page and card. Wrap off in [2–5] h. Explain touch-ups.
10	**Breakdown**	10 min	Cartridges to sharps; caps, film, towels to waste. Disinfect all surfaces.
11	**Record**	5 min	Log ink brand, color, lot #, cartridges and time. Book touch-ups.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Crisp, consistent lines; solid, even fill
- Nothing reused: needle, cap, ink, razor, glove
- Moles and broken skin avoided; no overworking
- Sharps never recapped; container below fill line

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Fainting or dizziness: stop, recline the client with legs raised. Water and sugar; resume only if fully well.
- Allergic reaction (hives, swelling): stop, remove the wrap. Breathing trouble or face swelling: call 911.
- Ink or antiseptic in the eye: flush with eyewash for 15 minutes, then seek medical care.
- Excessive bleeding: stop, firm pressure with clean gauze. Pause or reschedule; recheck blood thinners.
- Needle-stick: wash with soap and water, report it to the studio owner, follow your OSHA exposure plan.
- Seizure: move equipment away, don't restrain, time it. Call 911 if over 5 minutes.

Always write an incident report, note the ink lot and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Ink brand · color · lot #	Ink expiry	Cartridges (RL/RS/M1)	Machine · voltage
Placement · size	**Numbing product**	**Wrap used**	**Time · initials**

AFTERCARE

Caring for Your New Tattoo

For the first couple of weeks your tattoo is a healing wound. Clean, gentle, simple care helps it heal smoothly and keeps the lines and color at their best.

YOUR LOGO

WHEN	WHAT'S NORMAL	DO	AVOID
First day wrap on	Redness, tenderness and swelling. Clear plasma and a little ink seep out.	Wrap off after [2–5] hours. Wash with clean hands, lukewarm water and fragrance-free soap. Pat dry.	Re-wrapping in plastic, scrubbing, or sleeping on it. Alcohol tonight.
Days 2–3 settling	Oozing slows. It may feel warm and tight, and look shiny or slightly raised.	Wash [2–3] times a day. Let it air-dry, then add a very thin layer of ointment.	Thick ointment or petroleum jelly. Tight clothes rubbing the area.
Days 4–14 peeling	Flaking, peeling and itching. Colors can look cloudy or dull for a while.	Switch to fragrance-free lotion, thin layers, a few times a day. Loose, clean clothes.	Picking, scratching or slapping. Pools, baths, hot tubs, the sea and sun.
Weeks 2–4 healed surface	Skin looks healed but may stay shiny. Deeper healing goes on for weeks.	Keep moisturizing. Once fully healed, SPF 30+ every time it sees sun.	Tanning beds and sunburn. Any touch-up before [4–6] weeks.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Change your sheets and pillowcase tonight
- Fragrance-free products only until healed
- Colored flakes are normal, not lost ink
- Gym: wait [48] hours, wipe equipment first
- Short showers are fine; avoid a direct spray
- No antibiotic creams unless a doctor prescribes them
- Keep pets off the bed and away from it
- Healing takes longer on hands, feet and joints

Clean hands
Before every touch.

Thin layers
A little goes a long way.

Hands off
Let flakes fall off.

Shade it
No sun, then SPF for life.

CALL ME AND SEE A DOCTOR IF YOU NOTICE

- Redness or swelling spreading after day 3
- Yellow or green pus, or a bad smell
- Red streaks, heat or severe throbbing pain
- Fever, chills, a rash, hives or lasting bumps

Any of these: see your doctor, then text me so I can log the ink batch.

Swelling of the face or throat, or trouble breathing: call 911.

PLACEMENT & DATE

OINTMENT & LOTION TO USE

TOUCH-UP CHECK BY

CLIENT FORM · INFORMED CONSENT

Cover-up & Rework Consent

YOUR LOGO

CLIENT NAME | BIRTH DATE | PHOTO ID TYPE · LAST 4 | DATE

WHAT IT IS
Covering an old tattoo with a new design, or reworking one, including another artist's work.

WHAT TO EXPECT
Usually darker and larger than the old tattoo and built around it. Plan for [2 or more] sessions.

BEFORE WE START
Very dark ink may need laser fading by a licensed provider first, often [2–4] sessions.

TODAY'S WORK ☐ Full cover-up ☐ Blast-over ☐ Rework ☐ Other artist's work ☐ Laser-faded

POSSIBLE RISKS AND SIDE EFFECTS

- Parts of the old tattoo showing through, now or later
- Old scar tissue taking ink unevenly or blowing out
- Allergy to ink, even years later (red is most common)
- Raised scars or keloids, mainly in scar-prone skin
- More swelling and a longer heal from heavy saturation
- Extra sessions or touch-ups being needed
- Infection, most often from aftercare problems
- Rare burning or tingling during an MRI scan

About your existing tattoo. A cover-up can't erase it. Your artist will tell you honestly what can be hidden and may suggest laser fading first. Before photos are taken today. Initials

Quick health and skin check

- Pregnant or breastfeeding
- Immune suppression or chemo
- Accutane in last [6–12] months
- Sunburn, rash or cut at the site
- Blood thinners or bleeding disorder
- Heart condition or epilepsy
- Laser in last [6–8] weeks
- Allergy: latex, ink or ointment
- Diabetes
- Keloid or raised scars
- Scarring in the old tattoo
- Reaction to the old ink

☐ **None of these apply to me** or list any that do:

Please initial each statement

	Initials
I've shared my full health history and what I know about my old tattoo, including laser and past reactions.	
I understand a cover-up is limited by the old tattoo. Some of it may still show, and no result is guaranteed.	
I accept the new design may need to be darker, larger or placed differently than I first pictured.	
Rework of another artist's tattoo is done as is; [Your Business Name] isn't responsible for the original work.	
I approved the final design and stencil placement, and checked all spelling, names and dates.	
Plan: [__] sessions, [3–4] weeks apart. Extra sessions follow policy; any laser is booked separately.	
Ink brand, color and lot # are logged on my session record so I can be contacted if an ink is recalled.	
Before photos are required. Social media use only with my separate release. No refunds once work starts.	

By signing, I confirm I am 18 or older with valid photo ID (copy kept on file), am not under the influence of alcohol or drugs, have read this form, had my questions answered, and consent to this cover-up or rework.

CLIENT SIGNATURE | DATE | ARTIST · LICENSE # | DATE

ARTIST PROTOCOL

Cover-up & Rework

Plan from before photos. Times in [brackets] are guides. Check your state and local health department rules.

SCREEN

Intake, ID and cover-up consent signed. Old tattoo fully healed. Original artist noted.

ASSESS OLD WORK

Darkness, saturation, scarring and size. Too dark? Refer for laser fading first.

SET EXPECTATIONS

New design larger or darker. Old ink may show through. [2+] sessions likely.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Before photos taken ☐ Barrier film on machine, cord, chair ☐ Nitrile gloves ☐ Sealed single-use cartridges ☐ Ink caps poured per client ☐ Sharps container ☐ Ink lot # noted

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & photos**	15 min	Review intake and ID. Photograph the old tattoo from 2 angles in good light.
2	**Set up station**	10 min	Disinfect, barrier film on. Open cartridges in front of the client.
3	**Skin prep**	5 min	Shave with a single-use razor, then antiseptic. Note scars and raised lines.
4	**Stencil & approval**	15 min	Map old dark areas under the new design. Client approves in a mirror.
5	**Lining**	[ ] min	Line over old work only where planned. Don't trace old lines that will show.
6	**Packing & shading**	[ ] min	Saturate dark zones fully. Go gently over scar tissue; don't overwork.
7	**Wipe-down & check**	5 min	Check old lines are hidden where planned. After photos for the record.
8	**Wrap**	5 min	Thin ointment, wrap or film as agreed. Heavy fill weeps more.
9	**Aftercare review**	5 min	Heavy saturation may heal slower. Next session in [3–4] weeks.
10	**Breakdown**	10 min	Cartridges and razor to sharps; caps, film, towels to waste. Disinfect.
11	**Record**	5 min	Log inks, lots, photos and what is left to cover. Book the next session.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Old tattoo hidden where planned; no grey shadow
- Before and after photos saved with the record
- Solid saturation; scar tissue not overworked
- Nothing reused; sharps never recapped

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Fainting or dizziness: stop, recline the client with legs raised. Water and sugar; resume only if fully well.
- Allergic reaction (hives, swelling): stop, remove the wrap. Breathing trouble or face swelling: call 911.
- Scar tissue or old ink won't take: stop on that area. Let it heal and reassess.
- Excessive bleeding: stop, firm pressure with clean gauze. Pause or reschedule; recheck blood thinners.
- Needle-stick: wash with soap and water, report it to the studio owner, follow your OSHA exposure plan.
- Raised old lines or keloid signs: stop, photograph, refer to a doctor before more work.

Always write an incident report, note the ink lot and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Ink brand · color · lot #	Ink expiry	Cartridges used	Machine · voltage
Old tattoo notes	**Session # of [ ]**	**Laser fading first?**	**Time · initials**

AFTERCARE

Caring for Your Cover-Up

Cover-ups use denser lines and more saturated ink, so they can look darker and more raised while they heal. Gentle care gives the new design its best result.

YOUR LOGO

WHEN	WHAT'S NORMAL	DO	AVOID
First day wrap on	More redness, swelling and oozing than usual, from heavier packing.	Wrap off at [2–5] hours. Wash gently with fragrance-free soap. Pat dry.	Re-wrapping, scrubbing, sleeping on it or alcohol tonight.
Days 2–4 dark & raised	Darker and bolder than it will heal. Feels tight, warm or puffy.	Wash [2–3] times a day. A very thin layer of ointment for [3–4] days.	Thick ointment that traps moisture. Tight sleeves or straps.
Days 5–14 peeling	Thicker flakes. The old design may seem to show through.	Thin fragrance-free lotion. Let flakes come off by themselves.	Picking, which can pull out ink. Soaking, swimming, sun.
Weeks 3–6 settling	Color softens into its healed tone. Some spots may need another pass.	Send me a photo at [4–6] weeks. Book any planned session.	Sun and tanning beds. Judging it before it has healed.

While it heals

Heavy saturation sits darker and higher at first, and the old tattoo can peek through as new ink settles. Give it [4–6] weeks before judging the final look; we will check it together.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Cover-ups often need [2] or more sessions
- Fully heal between sessions, usually [4–6] weeks
- Fragrance-free products only; no antibiotic creams
- Laser-faded skin may heal more slowly; tell me
- Old scar tissue can take ink unevenly
- Change sheets tonight; wear loose, clean clothes

Be patient
Darker is normal.

Thin layers
A little goes a long way.

Hands off
Let flakes fall off.

Photo check
A picture at [4–6] weeks.

CALL ME AND SEE A DOCTOR IF YOU NOTICE

- Redness or swelling spreading after day 3
- Yellow or green pus, or a bad smell
- Red streaks, heat or severe throbbing pain
- Fever, chills, a rash, hives or lasting bumps

Any of these: see your doctor, then text me so I can log the ink batch.

Swelling of the face or throat, or trouble breathing: call 911.

PLACEMENT & DATE

PRODUCTS TO USE

NEXT SESSION

INFORMED CONSENT

Fine Line & Micro Tattoo Consent

YOUR LOGO

CLIENT NAME | BIRTH DATE | PHOTO ID TYPE · LAST 4 | DATE

WHAT IT IS
Single-needle or fine-line work and small designs, often under [2] inches, with fine detail.

WHAT TO EXPECT
Usually [30–90] minutes. Lines go in slowly and with a light hand to help keep them crisp.

HOW IT AGES
Fine lines soften, blur and fade over the years more than bold work. A touch-up is often needed.

TODAY'S TATTOO ☐ Single needle ☐ Fine line ☐ Micro ☐ Script ☐ Dotwork ☐ Touch-up booked

POSSIBLE RISKS AND SIDE EFFECTS

- Blowout: ink spreading into a blur that can't be undone
- Patchy or broken lines after healing
- Tiny details merging together over time
- Allergy to ink, or infection, as with any tattoo
- Lines softening, blurring or spreading as skin ages
- Faster fading on hands, fingers, feet and ribs
- Quick fading if the tattoo gets too much sun
- Rare burning or tingling during an MRI scan

Quick health and skin check

- Pregnant or breastfeeding
- Immune suppression or chemo
- Accutane in last [6–12] months
- Moles in the design area
- Blood thinners or bleeding disorder
- Thin or sun-damaged skin
- Sunburn, tan or rash at the site
- Allergy: latex, ink or ointment
- Diabetes or slow healing
- Keloid or raised scars
- Eczema or psoriasis
- Heart condition or epilepsy

☐ **None of these apply to me** or list any that do: _____

Size and placement. Very small text and detail blur together as skin ages. Your artist may suggest a larger size or a spot that holds fine work better.

☐ Going with the suggested size
☐ Keeping my size; I accept the risk

Please initial each statement

	Initials
I've shared my full health and medication history, including any numbing product I applied today.	
I understand fine lines can blur, spread and fade over time, and crisp healed lines aren't guaranteed.	
I approved the final design, size and placement, and checked all spelling, names, dates and numbers.	
A touch-up is often needed. It's done no sooner than [4–6] weeks and free within [1–3] months, per policy.	
Hands, fingers, feet and ribs fade faster and may be excluded from free touch-ups.	
I'll care for it gently with a thin layer of ointment, keep it out of the sun, then use SPF 30+ once healed.	
Ink brand, color and lot # are logged on my session record so I can be contacted if an ink is recalled.	
Photos for my record are OK; social media only with my separate release. Fees follow studio policy.	

By signing, I confirm I am 18 or older with valid photo ID (copy kept on file), am not under the influence of alcohol or drugs, have read this form, had my questions answered, and consent to this fine line tattoo.

CLIENT SIGNATURE | DATE | ARTIST · LICENSE # | DATE

ARTIST PROTOCOL

Fine Line & Micro Tattoo

Light hand, shallow depth. Times in [brackets] are guides. Check your state and local health department rules.

SCREEN

Intake, ID and fine-line consent signed. Not intoxicated, pregnant or breastfeeding.

PLACEMENT & SIZE

Hands, fingers, feet and ribs blur or fade faster. Advise a minimum size of [ ] in.

SKIN CHECK

Thin, soft or sun-damaged skin blows out easily. Moles: work around, never over.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Barrier film on machine, cord, chair ☐ Nitrile gloves ☐ Sealed single-use 1RL–3RL ☐ Ink caps poured per client ☐ Sharps container ☐ Ink lot # noted

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & consent**	10 min	Review intake, ID and meds. Explain blur, fading and touch-up odds.
2	**Set up station**	10 min	Disinfect, barrier film on. Open single-needle cartridges in front of client.
3	**Skin prep**	5 min	Shave with a single-use razor, then antiseptic. Keep the skin dry.
4	**Stencil & approval**	10 min	Fine, clean stencil. Client checks size, placement and spelling; initials.
5	**Test line**	2 min	Short line inside the design to judge depth and how the skin gives.
6	**Lining**	[ ] min	Low voltage, slow steady hand, firm stretch. One pass where possible.
7	**Soft shading**	[ ] min	Light whip or stipple. Don't stack passes; stop if the skin puffs up.
8	**Wipe-down**	5 min	Dab gently, never scrub. Check for blowout or uneven lines. Photos.
9	**Wrap**	5 min	Very thin ointment, or second-skin film as agreed.
10	**Aftercare review**	5 min	Little ointment, strict sun care. Touch-up check at [6–8] weeks.
11	**Breakdown & record**	10 min	Sharps, waste, surfaces. Log needle size, voltage, inks and lot #.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Crisp, even lines; no blowout halo
- Client told a touch-up is often needed
- Minimal trauma: one pass, light hand
- Nothing reused; sharps never recapped

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Fainting or dizziness: stop, recline the client with legs raised. Water and sugar; resume only if fully well.
- Allergic reaction (hives, swelling): stop, remove the wrap. Breathing trouble or face swelling: call 911.
- Blowout appears: stop deepening that line. Note it and reassess after healing.
- Excessive bleeding: stop, firm pressure with clean gauze. Pause or reschedule; recheck blood thinners.
- Needle-stick: wash with soap and water, report it to the studio owner, follow your OSHA exposure plan.
- Lines skipping on hands or feet: don't overwork. Book a touch-up once healed.

Always write an incident report, note the ink lot and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Ink brand · color · lot #	Ink expiry	Needle (1RL–3RL)	Machine · voltage
Placement · size	**Numbing product**	**Blowout noted?**	**Time · initials**

AFTERCARE

Caring for Your Fine Line Tattoo

Fine lines hold less ink than bold work, so they need the gentlest care. Light washing, little product and strict sun care keep them crisp.

YOUR LOGO

WHEN	WHAT'S NORMAL	DO	AVOID
First day wrap on	Light redness and a little swelling. Lines can look slightly fuzzy or raised.	Wrap off at [2–5] hours. Wash softly with fingertips and fragrance-free soap.	Washcloths, loofahs, scrubbing, or a strong shower stream on it.
Days 2–3 swelling settles	Lines may look thicker or blurry from swelling. This settles.	Pat dry. A rice-grain amount of ointment, only if it feels dry.	Heavy ointment, which softens lines. Makeup or perfume on it.
Days 4–14 light flaking	Light flaking and itching. Lines can look patchy for a while.	Thin fragrance-free lotion once or twice a day. Loose clothing, clean bedding.	Picking or rubbing. Pools, baths, hot tubs and sun.
Weeks 3–6 crisp again	Lines settle crisp and fine. Small gaps may show where ink did not hold.	SPF 30+ once healed. Send me a photo at [4–6] weeks if you see gaps.	Tanning beds and sunburn. Any touch-up before [4–6] weeks.

Sun & fading

UV is the biggest reason fine lines fade. Keep it covered until healed, then SPF 30+ every day it sees sun. Touch-ups are common with fine line work; tell me if a line looks thin.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Less is more: too much moisture blurs fine lines
- Lines soften and spread a little over the years
- Keep retinol and exfoliating acids off until healed
- Hands, fingers and feet fade fastest
- A light fade at [4–6] weeks is common
- Wash your hands every time before you touch it

Feather light
Fingertips only.

Rice grain
A tiny dab only.

Hands off
Let flakes fall off.

SPF daily
Sun fades fine lines.

CALL ME AND SEE A DOCTOR IF YOU NOTICE

- Redness or swelling spreading after day 3
- Yellow or green pus, or a bad smell
- Red streaks, heat or severe throbbing pain
- Fever, chills, a rash, hives or lasting bumps

Any of these: see your doctor, then text me so I can log the ink batch.

Swelling of the face or throat, or trouble breathing: call 911.

PLACEMENT & DATE

PRODUCTS TO USE

TOUCH-UP CHECK BY

INFORMED CONSENT · COLOR & MULTI-SESSION

Large-Scale & Realism Consent

YOUR LOGO

CLIENT NAME | BIRTH DATE | PHOTO ID TYPE · LAST 4 | DATE

WHAT IT IS
Sleeves, back pieces and detailed color or realism work, built over several sessions from one design.

WHAT TO EXPECT
Sessions of [3–6] hours. Eat a full meal, drink water and sleep well first. Breaks are built in.

BETWEEN SESSIONS
Each area heals [3–4] weeks before it is worked on again. The session count is an estimate.

SESSION PLAN

SESSIONS (EST.) | RATE | DEPOSIT / SESSION | TODAY: # OF #

POSSIBLE RISKS AND SIDE EFFECTS

- Swelling, bruising and soreness across a large area
- A longer, itchier heal, often [3–6] weeks per area
- Color fading faster in sun; uneven healing
- Raised scars or keloids, mainly in scar-prone skin
- Fatigue, light-headedness or fainting in long sessions
- Allergy to ink, most often red, even years later
- Infection if a large area isn't kept clean
- Rare burning or tingling during an MRI scan

Quick health check

- Pregnant or breastfeeding
- Immune suppression or chemo
- Low blood sugar or anemia
- Allergy: red ink, latex, ointment
- Blood thinners or bleeding disorder
- Heart condition or pacemaker
- Keloid or raised scars
- Sunburn, rash or cut on the area
- Diabetes
- Epilepsy or fainting
- Accutane in last [6–12] months
- Alcohol or drugs in last 24 hours

☐ **None of these apply to me** or list any that do: _____

Numbing: [studio policy]. The FDA warns against lidocaine over 4% or heavy use over large areas.

Please initial each statement

	Initials
I've shared my full health history, including medications and any numbing product I applied today.	
I approved the overall design and placement, and checked all spelling. Later changes may add sessions.	
Session count and total cost are estimates. If I stop early, the piece may look unfinished.	
A non-refundable deposit of [$__] holds each session and is applied to that session; a no-show forfeits it.	
I'll let each area heal [3–4] weeks between sessions and follow aftercare after every session.	
I'll eat, hydrate and rest before each session and tell my artist right away if I feel faint or unwell.	
Ink brand, color and lot # are logged each session so I can be contacted if an ink is recalled.	
Before and progress photos for my record are OK. Social media use only with my separate release.	

By signing, I confirm I am 18 or older with valid photo ID (copy kept on file), am not under the influence of alcohol or drugs, have read this form, had my questions answered, and consent to this multi-session plan.

CLIENT SIGNATURE | DATE | ARTIST · LICENSE # | DATE

ARTIST PROTOCOL

Color, Realism & Large-Scale

One session of a planned piece. Times in [brackets] are guides. Check your state and local health department rules.

SCREEN

Intake, ID and consent signed. Ate, slept and hydrated. Last session fully healed.

SESSION PLAN

Session [ ] of [ ]. Today's area agreed. Breaks every [60–90] min.

ALLERGY & NUMBING

Red ink and adhesive reactions asked. Max 4% lidocaine, never over large areas.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Barrier film on machine, cord, bottles, chair ☐ Nitrile gloves, spares ☐ Sealed single-use cartridges ☐ Ink caps poured per client ☐ Sharps container ☐ Water and snack ready

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & plan**	15 min	Check intake, ID and healing of prior work. Agree today's area and hours.
2	**Set up station**	15 min	Disinfect, barrier film on. Lay out cartridges and caps for the session.
3	**Skin prep**	10 min	Shave the area with a single-use razor, then antiseptic. Position for comfort.
4	**Stencil & approval**	15 min	Stencil or freehand map that flows with prior sections. Client initials.
5	**Lining**	[ ] min	Line today's section only. Wipe often; keep worked areas covered.
6	**Shading & color**	[ ] min	Grey wash or color as planned. Saturate without overworking.
7	**Breaks**	10 min	Every [60–90] min: gloves off, water, snack. Fresh gloves, recheck skin.
8	**Wipe-down**	5 min	Clean the whole worked area. After photos for the session plan.
9	**Wrap**	10 min	Thin ointment; wrap or large film with no gaps. Expect heavy weeping.
10	**Aftercare review**	5 min	More swelling, longer heal. Next session in [3–4] weeks, once healed.
11	**Breakdown & record**	15 min	Sharps, waste, surfaces. Log every ink lot, session # and area done.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Today's section done; edges soft for next time
- Stop early if the client is pale, shaky or swelling
- Even saturation; skin not chewed or overworked
- Nothing reused; sharps never recapped

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Fainting or dizziness: stop, recline the client with legs raised. Water and sugar; resume only if fully well.
- Allergic reaction (hives, swelling): stop, remove the wrap. Breathing trouble or face swelling: call 911.
- Skin puffy or weeping heavily: stop for today. It will heal and take ink better.
- Excessive bleeding: stop, firm pressure with clean gauze. Pause or reschedule; recheck blood thinners.
- Needle-stick: wash with soap and water, report it to the studio owner, follow your OSHA exposure plan.
- Client exhausted or shaking: stop, water and sugar. End early and rebook.

Always write an incident report, note the ink lot and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Ink brands · colors · lot #s	Ink expiry	Cartridges used	Machine · voltage
Session # · area done	**Numbing product**	**Hours · breaks**	**Next session · initials**

AFTERCARE

Caring for Your Large Tattoo

Big, color-packed pieces ask more of your body. Expect more swelling and a longer heal, and let each session heal before the next.

YOUR LOGO

WHEN	WHAT'S NORMAL	DO	AVOID
First day wrap on	Big areas swell, ooze and feel sore like a sunburn. You may feel tired.	Wrap off at [2–5] hours. Wash with fragrance-free soap, pat dry. Rest, drink water.	Alcohol, hard workouts, long drives. Sleeping on it.
Days 2–4 peak swelling	Swelling, warmth and stiffness peak, mostly on legs and arms.	Raise a swollen limb. Very thin ointment for [3–4] days.	Tight sleeves, waistbands or straps. Thick product that traps heat.
Days 5–21 peeling	Peeling and itching over a big area. Color looks milky.	Thin fragrance-free lotion. Loose, soft clothing. Warm showers.	Scratching or picking. Pools, baths, hot tubs, the sea, sun.
Weeks 3–6 settling	Surface heals but stays shiny longer. Color settles in.	SPF 30+ once healed; color fades fast in UV. Confirm your next session.	Working over unhealed skin. Sunburn before a session.

Next session

Heal fully before your next session, usually [3–4] weeks. Moisturize, stay out of the sun, and arrive rested, fed and hydrated. Tell me about new medications, illness or sunburn first.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Big pieces can take [4–6] weeks or more to heal
- Red and bright inks can react later; tell me
- Fragrance-free products only; no antibiotic creams
- Change your sheets tonight and every few days
- Eat a full meal and bring snacks to long sessions
- Wash your hands every time before you touch it

Rest up
Sleep, food and water.

Thin layers
A little goes a long way.

Hands off
Let flakes fall off.

Wait [3–4] weeks
Heal between sessions.

CALL ME AND SEE A DOCTOR IF YOU NOTICE

- Redness or swelling spreading after day 3
- Yellow or green pus, or a bad smell
- Red streaks, heat or severe throbbing pain
- Fever, chills, a rash, hives or lasting bumps

Any of these: see your doctor, then text me so I can log the ink batch.

Swelling of the face or throat, or trouble breathing: call 911.

SESSION # & DATE _____

PRODUCTS TO USE _____

NEXT SESSION DATE _____

CLIENT FORM · INFORMED CONSENT

Touch-up Consent

YOUR LOGO

CLIENT NAME | BIRTH DATE | PHOTO ID TYPE · LAST 4 | DATE

WHAT IT IS
A short session to fill patchy spots, faded lines or light areas in a fully healed tattoo.

WHEN IT'S DONE
Once fully healed, no sooner than [4–6] weeks. Free once within [1–3] months of your session.

NOT INCLUDED
Design changes, additions, and wear from sun, picking or poor aftercare are quoted as new work.

ORIGINAL SESSION | DATE | ARTIST | PLACEMENT | INK LOT #

POSSIBLE RISKS AND SIDE EFFECTS

- Touched-up areas looking darker for a few weeks
- Scar tissue or blowout that can't be corrected
- Infection, most often from aftercare problems
- Patchiness that still needs a second pass
- Allergy to ink, even if you healed well before
- Rare burning or tingling during an MRI scan

Anything changed since your session?

- Pregnant or breastfeeding
- Accutane in last [6–12] months
- Still scabbing or peeling
- Reaction after last session
- New medications
- New diagnosis or surgery
- Sunburn or tan on the tattoo
- Rash or cut on the site
- Blood thinners
- Diabetes or immune issues
- Raised or itchy lines
- Keloid or raised scars

☐ **Nothing has changed** or list any that do: _____

Free touch-up exclusions. Hands, fingers, feet and face [and other areas]; fading from sun, picking, soaking or skipped aftercare; and work by another studio.

☐ Eligible: free touch-up
☐ Paid touch-up: [$__]

Please initial each statement

	Initials
I've told my artist about any health, medication or skin changes since my last session.	
My tattoo is fully healed, with no scabs, shiny skin or peeling, and at least [4–6] weeks have passed.	
Free touch-ups are offered once, within [1–3] months of my session, per [Your Business Name] policy.	
I understand excluded areas and aftercare-related fading are charged, and some flaws can't be fixed.	
Any change to the design or lettering is new work. I'll approve it and check the spelling before we start.	
Ink brand, color and lot # used today are logged with my original record for recall tracking.	
I'll follow aftercare again for about [1–2] weeks and see a doctor if signs of infection appear.	
Before and after photos for my record are OK. Social media use only with my separate release.	

By signing, I confirm I am 18 or older with valid photo ID (copy kept on file), am not under the influence of alcohol or drugs, have read this form, had my questions answered, and consent to this touch-up.

CLIENT SIGNATURE | DATE | ARTIST · LICENSE # | DATE

ARTIST PROTOCOL

Touch-up

Pull the original record first. Times in [brackets] are guides. Check your state and local health department rules.

SCREEN

Fully healed: at least [4–6] weeks since the session. Intake updated, ID checked.

ELIGIBILITY

Within [1–3] months? Hands, feet, fingers and face often excluded. Fee: [ ].

FIND THE CAUSE

Healing gap, blowout or aftercare? Sun damage and picking are not covered.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Original record pulled ☐ Barrier film on machine, cord, chair ☐ Nitrile gloves ☐ Sealed single-use cartridges ☐ Ink caps poured per client ☐ Sharps container

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & review**	10 min	Pull the original record. Check healing, ID and any health changes.
2	**Assess & photos**	5 min	Mark gaps, light spots and uneven lines in good light. Before photos.
3	**Set up station**	10 min	Disinfect, barrier film on. Open cartridges in front of the client.
4	**Skin prep**	5 min	Shave with a single-use razor if needed, then antiseptic.
5	**Client approval**	5 min	Show each spot you will work. Note anything not covered.
6	**Line touch-up**	[ ] min	Match the original needle and depth. Fix gaps; don't retrace whole lines.
7	**Fill & color**	[ ] min	Same ink and lot where possible. Light passes on healed skin.
8	**Wipe & wrap**	5 min	Gentle wipe, after photos. Thin ointment, then wrap or small film.
9	**Aftercare review**	5 min	Short heal of about [1–2] weeks. Same care: no soaking, sun or picking.
10	**Breakdown**	10 min	Cartridges and razor to sharps; caps, film, towels to waste. Disinfect.
11	**Record**	5 min	Log inks, lots and areas on the original record. Note free or fee.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Gaps filled; color matches the healed work
- Before and after photos linked to the record
- Only target areas worked; minimal trauma
- Nothing reused; sharps never recapped

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Fainting or dizziness: stop, recline the client with legs raised. Water and sugar; resume only if fully well.
- Allergic reaction (hives, swelling): stop, remove the wrap. Breathing trouble or face swelling: call 911.
- Same spot heals patchy again: stop and ask about aftercare. Note skin type.
- Excessive bleeding: stop, firm pressure with clean gauze. Pause or reschedule; recheck blood thinners.
- Needle-stick: wash with soap and water, report it to the studio owner, follow your OSHA exposure plan.
- Signs of past infection or scarring: don't work over it. Refer to a doctor.

Always write an incident report, note the ink lot and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Original session date	Ink brand · color · lot #	Cartridges used	Machine · voltage
Areas touched up	**Free or fee [ ]**	**Cause noted**	**Time · initials**

AFTERCARE

Caring for Your Touch-Up

A touch-up is fresh work on small areas of healed skin. It usually heals faster, in about [1–2] weeks, but needs the same gentle care.

YOUR LOGO

WHEN	WHAT'S NORMAL	DO	AVOID
First day wrap on	New spots look darker, shiny and raised next to healed areas.	Wrap off at [2–5] hours. Wash gently with fragrance-free soap. Pat dry.	Re-wrapping in plastic. Scrubbing or rubbing the new spots.
Days 2–3 settling	Light oozing and tenderness on the reworked spots only.	Wash [2–3] times a day. Thin ointment for [2–3] days, then lotion.	Heavy ointment over the whole tattoo. Tight clothes rubbing it.
Days 4–10 flaking	Small flakes and itching. New spots may look cloudy.	Thin fragrance-free lotion. Let flakes fall off on their own.	Picking or scratching. Pools, baths, hot tubs, sun for [1–2] weeks.
Weeks 2–4 blending in	New ink blends into the rest of the tattoo as the skin settles.	SPF 30+ once healed. Send a photo if a spot looks patchy.	Any more work there for [4–6] weeks while deep skin heals.

Touch-up policy

Free within [1–3] months of your session, once healed (no sooner than [4–6] weeks). Hands, fingers, feet and face [not included]. Fading from sun or skipped aftercare [is charged].

GOOD TO KNOW

- Thin spots most often come from picking or sun
- Your touch-up is noted on your original record
- No antibiotic creams unless a doctor prescribes them
- Hands, feet and fingers fade fastest, even with care
- Fragrance-free products only until healed
- Change sheets tonight; wear loose, clean clothes

Clean hands
Before every touch.

Thin layers
A little goes a long way.

Hands off
Let flakes fall off.

Shade it
No sun, then SPF for life.

CALL ME AND SEE A DOCTOR IF YOU NOTICE

- Redness or swelling spreading after day 3
- Yellow or green pus, or a bad smell
- Red streaks, heat or severe throbbing pain
- Fever, chills, a rash, hives or lasting bumps

Any of these: see your doctor, then text me so I can log the ink batch.

Swelling of the face or throat, or trouble breathing: call 911.

ORIGINAL SESSION DATE _____

TOUCH-UP DATE _____

PRODUCTS TO USE _____

INFORMED CONSENT

Second-Skin Healing Consent

YOUR LOGO

CLIENT NAME | BIRTH DATE | PHOTO ID TYPE · LAST 4 | DATE

WHAT IT IS
A clear, breathable adhesive film, such as [brand], placed over your fresh tattoo to protect it as it starts to heal.

THE TIMELINE
First piece off at [8–24] hours, then wash. A second piece can stay up to [6] days. Never more than [7] days total.

WHAT'S NORMAL
A pocket of plasma, ink and fluid under the film in the first day or two. It looks messy but is expected.

TODAY'S PLAN ☐ First piece applied ☐ Second piece supplied ☐ Film brand: [ ] ☐ Switch to traditional

POSSIBLE RISKS AND SIDE EFFECTS

- Adhesive allergy: itching, bumps or rash under the film
- Bacteria getting in if the seal leaks
- Bumps from hair or sweat trapped under the edges
- Allergy to ink, even years later (red is most common)
- Skin irritation or tearing if film is pulled off fast
- Infection if film stays on too long
- Heat rash in hot weather or during exercise
- Rare burning or tingling during an MRI scan

Adhesive check. Have you reacted to bandages, medical tape or clear film dressings? If you're not sure, a small test patch can go on [24 hours] before.

☐ No adhesive reactions
☐ Use traditional wrap instead

Quick health and skin check

- Adhesive or bandage allergy
- Eczema or psoriasis at the site
- Blood thinners or bleeding disorder
- Accutane in last [6–12] months
- Latex allergy
- Diabetes or slow healing
- Pregnant or breastfeeding
- Heavy sweating or hot job
- Fragile or very sensitive skin
- Immune suppression or chemo
- Keloid or raised scars
- Allergy: ink or ointment

☐ **None of these apply to me** or list any that do:

Please initial each statement

	Initials
I've shared any reaction to bandages, tape or adhesive film, plus my full health history.	
I'll remove the first piece after [8–24] hours, wash gently, and reapply only on clean, dry skin.	
The film comes off by day [6], and never stays on more than [7] days in total, even if it looks fine.	
I'll remove it early for a rash, itching, burning or fluid leaking past the edge, then switch to traditional care.	
I'll peel it slowly in a warm shower, low and in the direction of hair growth, never ripping it off.	
A fluid pocket is normal. Spreading redness, heat, pus, red streaks or fever mean I'll see a doctor.	
I approved the final design and placement and checked all spelling. Ink lot # is logged for recalls.	
Photos for my record are OK; social media only with my separate release. Fees follow studio policy.	

By signing, I confirm I am 18 or older with valid photo ID (copy kept on file), am not under the influence of alcohol or drugs, have read this form, had my questions answered, and consent to second-skin healing.

CLIENT SIGNATURE | DATE | ARTIST · LICENSE # | DATE

ARTIST PROTOCOL

Second-Skin Healing

Follow your film maker's directions. Times in [brackets] are guides. Check your state and local health department rules.

SCREEN
Intake, ID and second-skin consent signed. Not intoxicated, pregnant or breastfeeding.

ADHESIVE CHECK
Past reaction to bandages, tape or film? If yes, use plastic wrap instead.

SITE CHECK
Film needs a [1–2] in. margin of clear, dry skin. Allow extra margin on joints.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Barrier film on machine, cord, chair ☐ Nitrile gloves ☐ Sealed single-use cartridges ☐ Ink caps poured per client ☐ Sharps container ☐ Sealed film, cut to size

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & consent**	10 min	Review intake, ID and adhesive allergy. Confirm design and film plan.
2	**Set up station**	10 min	Disinfect, barrier film on. Open cartridges and film in front of client.
3	**Skin prep**	5 min	Shave the tattoo and margin with a single-use razor, then antiseptic.
4	**Stencil & approval**	10 min	Client checks placement and spelling in a mirror, then initials.
5	**Lining**	[ ] min	Firm stretch, steady depth. Wipe with a fresh towel each time.
6	**Shading & color**	[ ] min	As designed. Extra trauma means more fluid under the film.
7	**Wipe-down**	5 min	Stop surface bleeding. Rinse off all soap and ointment residue.
8	**Dry the skin**	5 min	Let the skin air-dry fully. No ointment under film; it won't seal.
9	**Apply film**	5 min	Cut [1–2] in. past the edges, round the corners. Smooth on; no stretch.
10	**Aftercare review**	5 min	First piece off at 8–24 h. Second up to [6] days; 7 days max in total.
11	**Breakdown & record**	10 min	Sharps, waste, surfaces. Log film brand and lot with the inks.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY
- Film sealed all round; no gaps or creases
- Client knows a plasma pocket is normal
- No ointment or moisture under the film
- Remove early if rash, itching or leaks

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG
- Fainting or dizziness: stop, recline the client with legs raised. Water and sugar; resume only if fully well.
- Allergic reaction (hives, swelling): stop, remove the wrap. Breathing trouble or face swelling: call 911.
- Film leaks or fluid passes the edge: remove, wash, then apply new film or plastic wrap.
- Excessive bleeding: stop, firm pressure with clean gauze. Pause or reschedule; recheck blood thinners.
- Needle-stick: wash with soap and water, report it to the studio owner, follow your OSHA exposure plan.
- Rash, itch or blisters under film: remove gently; switch to plastic wrap. Refer if spreading.

Always write an incident report, note the ink lot and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Ink brand · color · lot #	Ink expiry	Cartridges used	Machine · voltage
Film brand · lot	**Margin · pieces used**	**Adhesive reaction?**	**Time · initials**

AFTERCARE

Your Second-Skin Aftercare

Your tattoo is sealed under a clear, breathable adhesive film. It protects the skin as it heals, so there is less to do, but the timing matters.

YOUR LOGO

WHEN	WHAT'S NORMAL	DO	AVOID
Piece 1 [8–24] hours	Plasma and ink collect in a pocket under the film. It can look dark or messy.	Leave it on. Remove at [8–24] hours under warm water. Wash, pat dry.	Poking or draining the pocket. Re-sticking an edge that has lifted.
Piece 2 up to day [5–6]	Far less fluid. Skin may look cloudy or flaky under the film.	When skin is fully air-dry, apply piece 2 as shown. Smooth the edges.	Applying to damp skin or over ointment. Baths or pools.
Film off day [5–6]	Edges lift and the skin under it looks dull, dry and peeling.	Remove under warm water (see below). Wash, pat dry, then thin lotion.	Film on for more than [7] days in total. Ripping it off dry.
Weeks 2–4 finish healing	Light flaking and itching as the last layers heal.	Thin fragrance-free lotion. SPF 30+ once fully healed.	Picking, pools, baths, hot tubs and sun for [2–4] weeks.

Taking it off

In a warm shower, let water run over it for a few minutes. Lift an edge and peel slowly back over itself, low to the skin, in the direction of hair growth. Never rip it off.

GOOD TO KNOW

- The fluid pocket is normal, not infection
- Ink in the fluid is normal, not lost color
- Film off early? Switch to wash-and-lotion care
- Showers are fine; don't soak or swim with film on
- Body hair can make removal sting; go slowly
- Wash your hands before touching the film or skin

Leave it
Don't poke the pocket.

Dry skin
Piece 2 on dry skin only.

Warm water
Peel off in the shower.

[7] days max
Never longer in total.

TAKE THE FILM OFF, WASH AND TEXT ME IF YOU NOTICE

- Rash, itching or redness around the film edges
- Fluid leaking out or spreading past the edge
- Small blisters or bumps under the adhesive
- Redness or swelling spreading after day 3

Pus, red streaks, heat, fever or chills: please see your doctor.

Swelling of the face or throat, or trouble breathing: call 911.

PIECE 1 OFF BY _____

PIECE 2 OFF BY _____

FILM BRAND _____

GETTING READY

Before Your Tattoo Appointment

For every style, size and session. A little prep helps you sit comfortably, heal well and love your tattoo for years.

YOUR LOGO

NAME

APPOINTMENT DATE & TIME

DESIGN · PLACEMENT

1 week
before

Took Accutane in the last [6–12] months? Tell me before you book.

Keep the area out of the sun. Sunburned skin can't be tattooed.

Moisturize the area daily so your skin is soft.

On blood thinners? Ask your doctor first. Never stop a medication on your own.

48 hours
before

No alcohol for [24–48] hours. It thins your blood, and I can't tattoo anyone who has been drinking.

Sleep well and drink plenty of water.

No need to shave; I'll use a fresh single-use razor.

Check the area for cuts, rash or anything new.

Day of
your appointment

Bring photo ID. You must be 18 or older.

Eat a full meal [2–3] hours before, and bring a snack and a drink.

Wear loose clothes that give easy access to the area.

Numbing cream only with my OK; tell me exactly what you used.

Your design

· Final design is approved before the stencil goes on.

· Words and names: we check spelling together and you initial it.

· Size or placement changes on the day may change time and price.

Long sessions

· Large or color work: [3–4] weeks between sessions.

· Breaks are fine. Tell me if you feel faint or dizzy.

· Bring a charger, headphones and layers.

· [One guest / No guests] in the work area.

Cover-ups & touch-ups

· Cover-up: bring a photo of the old tattoo. Laser fading may come first.

· Touch-up: wait until fully healed, at least [4–6] weeks.

· Tell me how you cared for it while it healed.

PLEASE TEXT TO RESCHEDULE IF YOU HAVE

· A sunburn, rash, cut or infection at the site
· An eczema or psoriasis flare at the site
· Started Accutane or a blood thinner
· A fever, cold or flu, or feel unwell
· Found out you're pregnant or breastfeeding
· A cold sore, if we're working near your lips

I ask for [48–72] hours' notice to keep your deposit. Health or safety? Just text and we'll find a new time together.

Important

Pregnant or breastfeeding? We'll postpone to keep infection risk away from you and your baby. Tell me and I'll hold your design [and deposit, per studio policy] until you're ready.

DEPOSIT PAID

ESTIMATED SESSION LENGTH

NOTES FOR YOU

AFTERCARE · HEALING GUIDE

Your Tattoo Healing Guide

For the first few weeks your tattoo is a healing wound. Here's what to expect at each stage, how to care for it and when to see a doctor.

YOUR LOGO

First 24 hours

Wrap, wash, rest

WRAP OFF
Plastic wrap off after [2–5] hours, or follow your film plan.

FIRST WASH
Clean hands, lukewarm water, fragrance-free soap. Rinse gently.

PAT DRY
Use a clean paper towel, then let it air-dry.

SLEEP
Clean sheets and loose clothes. A little ink on the sheets is normal.

OOZING IS NORMAL
Clear fluid and a little ink for the first [1–2] days.

Daily care

Until fully healed

WASH
[2–3] times a day. Keep a hard shower stream off it.

OINTMENT
A thin layer for [3–4] days. It should never look wet or shiny.

LOTION
Then fragrance-free lotion [2–3] times a day until healed.

CLOTHING
Loose and clean. Tight straps and waistbands rub.

NO ANTIBIOTIC CREAMS
Unless a doctor prescribes them; they can irritate.

Protect

For [2–4] weeks

NO SOAKING
No baths, pools, hot tubs, sea, lakes or saunas.

SUN
Keep it covered and out of direct sun. No tanning beds.

HANDS OFF
No picking, scratching or slapping. Let flakes fall off.

WORKOUTS
Skip gym sessions that stretch or rub it for [48] hours.

ONCE HEALED
SPF 30+ every day keeps lines crisp.

Days 1–3

Red, warm, swollen and tender, with some oozing.

Days 4–14

Flaking, peeling and itching. Don't pick or scratch.

Weeks 2–4

The surface closes. It may look cloudy or shiny.

Months 1–3

Deeper skin heals and color settles. Big pieces take longer.

THIS IS NORMAL

- Redness and swelling for [2–3] days
- Clear or ink-tinged oozing early on
- Itching, flaking and light scabbing
- A milky, cloudy look as new skin forms
- Lines that puff up in heat for a few weeks
- Small patchy spots a touch-up can fix

SEE A DOCTOR IF YOU NOTICE

- Redness or swelling that spreads after day 3
- Red streaks, heat or throbbing pain
- Yellow or green pus, or a bad smell
- Fever or chills
- A rash, hives or itchy bumps in one color
- Hard lumps that last more than a week

Call 911 for trouble breathing or a swollen face or throat. **Seen a doctor?** Please tell me too, so I can note the ink lot.

MRI scan? Rare tingling or burning can happen. Tell your radiologist about your tattoos.

YOUR TOUCH-UP WINDOW

PRODUCTS I RECOMMEND

NOTES

ARTIST REFERENCE

Tattoo Artist Cheat Sheet

Right needle, right depth, clean lines and a traceable ink lot.

Needle groupings

CODE	GROUPING	BEST FOR	WATCH FOR
RL	Round liner	Outlines, lettering, detail	1RL is single needle. Tight = crisper.
RS	Round shader	Bold lines, small shaded areas	Looser cluster. Don't overwork.
M1	Magnum (weaved)	Shading and color fill, big areas	Two staggered rows. Corners can scar.
CM	Curved magnum	Smooth blends, soft gradients	Also RM. Gentler on the skin.
BP	Bugpin · taper	Fine lines, soft shading	#10 (0.30 mm) needles; finer flow.
F	Flat	Geometric fill, crisp edges	One straight row. Keep the angle.

Line, shade & pack

TECHNIQUE	HAND AND PASSES	GOAL · COMMON MISTAKE
Lining	Steady, one confident pass	Solid line at even depth. Too deep blows out; too shallow skips.
Shading	Light layers, whip or pendulum	Smooth gradients. Overworking scars and slows healing.
Color packing	Small, slow overlapping circles	Full saturation. Stop when skin turns shiny and puffy.

Placement: pain level and risk

●●○○○	●●●○○	●●●○○	●●●●●	●●●●●	●●●●○	●●●●○
Outer arm	**Forearm**	**Thigh**	**Ribs**	**Sternum**	**Hands · fingers**	**Feet · ankles**
Easy starter	Inner side thin	Inner side thin	Stretch firmly	Bony, sensitive	Fades fast	Blowout, fading

Wrap options compared

WRAP	WEAR TIME	PROS · WATCH FOR
Plastic wrap	[2–5] hours	Cheap and familiar. Not breathable; off the same day.
Non-stick pad	[2–5] hours	Absorbs fluid. Can stick if left on too long.
Second-skin film	8–24 h, then up to [6] days	Fewer washes. Ask about adhesive allergy; never over 7 days total.

SKIN & DEPTH

- **Depth:** ink sits in the upper dermis, about [1–2] mm.
- Thin or older skin: lighter hand, fewer passes.
- Keloid history: small test area first.
- Scars: wait until fully mature, about [12] months.
- Moles: work around them, never over.
- Stretchy areas: stretch firmly and evenly.

INK STORAGE & RECALLS

- **Log brand, color, lot # and expiry** per client.
- Store sealed, cool and dark; date when opened.
- Discard expired ink. Check FDA recalls [monthly].
- Single-use caps; never pour ink back.
- EU/UK: REACH-compliant inks with batch number.
- Recall? Pull the lot and check client records.

Every time. Follow maker instructions and health department rules. Depths are a guide; adjust to each client.

ARTIST REFERENCE

Tattoo Contraindication Chart

A quick screen, not a diagnosis. When in doubt, don't start and ask for written medical clearance.

KEY **No** Don't tattoo **Wait** Postpone until resolved **Doctor OK** Clearance first *Caution* Modify OK Proceed

IF CLIENT HAS	Standard	Cover-up	Fine line	Large	Touch-up	Second-skin
SKIN & SITE						
Sunburn or fresh tan at site [1]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Rash, cut, flare or infection [2]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Mole or raised spot at site [3]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*
Keloid or raised scar history [4]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*
Laser session at the site [5]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Hands, feet or fingers [6]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK	*Caution*	*Caution*
HEALTH & MEDICINES						
Pregnant or breastfeeding [7]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Blood thinners or bleeding [8]	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**
Diabetes [9]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	**Doctor OK**	*Caution*	*Caution*
Immune suppression, chemo [10]	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**
Heart condition or pacemaker [11]	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**
Epilepsy or fainting history [12]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*
Accutane in last [6–12] months [13]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Latex or adhesive allergy [14]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	**No**
Past ink reaction [15]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*
SESSION & CONSENT						
Fever or feeling unwell [16]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Alcohol or drugs in last 24 h [17]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Under 18 or no photo ID [18]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Numbing product applied [19]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*

[1] No tattooing burned or tanned skin. Wait until healed.
[2] Postpone until healed. Infection: see a doctor.
[3] Tattoo around it, never over, so it can be checked.
[4] Discuss the risk; small test spot first. Client initials.
[5] Wait until fully healed, about [6–8] weeks after laser.
[6] Fades and blurs faster; often no free touch-up.
[7] Postpone. Hold the design and deposit [policy].
[8] Bleeding disorders too. Never stop meds unadvised.
[9] Slower healing. Doctor OK for long sessions.
[10] Higher infection risk. Written doctor OK first.
[11] Doctor OK. Short sessions; know where meds are.
[12] Breaks, food and sugar on hand. Ask about their plan.
[13] Wait [6–12] months after the last dose.
[14] Nitrile gloves. No film; use plastic wrap or a pad.
[15] Avoid that color or brand; note the lot. Refer if unsure.
[16] Reschedule; no deposit penalty [policy].
[17] Refuse service. Deposit per policy.
[18] 18+ with photo ID. Minors only where law allows.
[19] Ask brand and amount. Max 4% lidocaine (FDA).

Conservative defaults; check your health department rules. Maker instructions and the client's doctor come first. Refer skin concerns to a doctor.

CONFIDENTIAL · INTERNAL RECORD

Reaction & Incident Report

Complete the same day. Record facts, not opinions. Keep the ink, lots and cartridges.

DATE | TIME | CLIENT NAME | CLIENT PHONE

SERVICE · PLACEMENT | ARTIST · LICENSE # | WITNESS, IF ANY

INK BRAND · COLORS | INK LOT #S · EXPIRY | NEEDLE · CARTRIDGE LOT #

What happened

☐ Allergic reaction ☐ Needle-stick or sharps injury ☐ Blood or fluid splash ☐ Fainting, dizziness
☐ Heavy bleeding ☐ Seizure ☐ Film rash or blistering ☐ Infection reported later ☐ Slip or fall ☐ Other

DESCRIBE IN ORDER: WHAT YOU SAW, WHERE, SIZE, WHEN IT STARTED, WHAT THE PERSON FELT

IMMEDIATE ACTIONS · TIME

- ☐ Stopped the session
- ☐ Faint: laid flat, legs raised, water, sugar
- ☐ Bleeding: gloves, pressure, clean dressing
- ☐ Sharps injury: washed with soap and water
- ☐ Splash to eye or mouth: flushed with water
- ☐ Sharp into the sharps container
- ☐ Photos taken with client consent
- ☐ **Called 911**
- ☐ Kept ink, lots, cartridges and packaging

REFERRAL DETAILS

☐ None ☐ Own doctor ☐ Urgent care, ER

Provider · phone

Date seen · outcome

NEEDLE-STICK OR EXPOSURE

☐ Artist ☐ Client ☐ Staff

Seen by a doctor · date, time

☐ Hep B vaccinated ☐ Not vaccinated ☐ Unknown

REPORTED TO

☐ Ink maker ☐ FDA MedWatch ☐ Health dept

Insurer · contact · ref #

CLIENT STATEMENT, IN THEIR WORDS

CHECK	DATE	HOW IT LOOKS · WHAT THEY REPORT · NEXT STEP	INITIALS
24 hours			
48 hours			
1 week			
1 month			

ARTIST SIGNATURE | DATE | CLIENT SIGNATURE, OPTIONAL | DATE

WEEKLY LOG · INITIAL EACH BOX

Sanitation & Sterilization Log

Health department rules and each label come first. Keep logs [3] years.

WEEK OF

STUDIO · STATION

REVIEWED BY

DISINFECTANT NAME · EPA REG. NO.

CONTACT TIME (MIN)

TASK	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Needles & cartridges single-use Sealed, opened in front of the client.							
Barrier film replaced Machine, clip cord, bottles, chair, lamp.							
Ink caps poured per client Never returned to the bottle; caps tossed.							
Station disinfected EPA-registered product, full contact time.							
Sharps container checked Within reach; swapped at the fill line.							
Reusable tools autoclaved Cleaned, pouched, run; cycle logged.							
Chemical indicators changed Strip color checked on every pouch.							
Gloves & hand washing New nitrile pair at each step; hands washed.							
Biohazard waste bagged Red bag, lidded bin; licensed hauler.							
Chair & surfaces wiped Armrests, trays, lamps between clients.							
Hand sink stocked Soap and paper towels; no shared towels.							

AUTOCLAVE	DATE	INITIALS
Spore test sent		
Spore result: pass · fail		
Cycle log reviewed		

WEEKLY CHECK	DATE	INITIALS
Sharps container swapped		
Ink expiry & FDA recalls		
First aid kit, eyewash		

STUDIO STATION RULES

- Spore test [weekly / monthly]; keep results.
- Single-use items: new per client, never reused.
- Failed spore test? Stop the unit; retest, reprocess.
- Never recap needles. Sharps straight in.
- OSHA bloodborne pathogens training yearly.
- Hep B vaccine offered to all staff.

NOTES · SUPPLIES TO REORDER · AUTOCLAVE ISSUES · INCIDENTS

Aftercare cards · 4 × 6 in · cut along the dotted lines

AFTERCARE

Standard Tattoo

First 3 days

a little oozing is normal

DO

· Wrap off in [2–5] hours, then wash gently
· Fragrance-free soap, lukewarm water
· Pat dry; thin ointment for [3–4] days
· Then fragrance-free lotion until healed

AVOID

· Soaking, pools or hot tubs for [2–4] weeks
· Sun on it; SPF 30+ once healed
· Picking, scratching or peeling flakes
· Tight clothing that rubs the area

Heals in about **[2–4] weeks**. Free touch-up within [3] months. **Next visit:** [date]

CALL ME IF

Redness, heat or swelling that spreads or worsens after day 3 · pus or red streaks · fever · rash or hives. See your doctor, then let me know.

Questions? Text [Phone] [Your Business Name]

AFTERCARE

Cover-up & Rework

First 3 days

dense ink can swell more

DO

· Wrap off in [2–5] hours, then wash gently
· Fragrance-free soap; pat dry, air-dry
· Thin ointment [3–4] days, then lotion
· Allow a longer heal over heavy ink

AVOID

· Soaking, pools or hot tubs for [2–4] weeks
· Sun, which fades the new layer fastest
· Picking scabs on saturated areas
· Judging the result before it heals

Next session or laser plan in **[6–8] weeks**, once fully healed. **Next visit:** [date]

CALL ME IF

Redness, heat or swelling that spreads after day 3 · pus or red streaks · fever · thick raised areas that last. Infection signs: see your doctor.

Questions? Text [Phone] [Your Business Name]

Aftercare cards · 4 × 6 in · cut along the dotted lines

AFTERCARE

Fine Line & Micro

First 3 days

go gentle, use less product

DO

· Wash gently 2–3 times a day
· Pat dry with a clean paper towel
· Thinnest layer of ointment, [2–3] days
· Fragrance-free lotion once it flakes
· SPF 30+ for life once healed

AVOID

· Thick ointment or tight bandages
· Rubbing, scrubbing or picking flakes
· Soaking, pools or hot tubs for [2–4] weeks
· Sun or tanning beds until healed

Fine lines often need a **touch-up**. Check in at [4–6] weeks: _____

CALL ME IF

Patchy or blurred lines once healed: text me. Spreading redness after day 3, pus, red streaks or fever: see your doctor.

Questions? Text [Phone] [Your Business Name]

AFTERCARE

Color, Realism & Large-Scale

First week

big pieces swell and ooze more

DO

· Rest, eat well and drink plenty of water
· Wash with clean hands, 2–3 times a day
· Thin ointment [3–4] days, then lotion
· Fresh sheets and loose, soft clothing

AVOID

· Soaking, pools or hot tubs for [2–4] weeks
· Gym, heavy sweat and friction for [3–5] days
· Sun on it; color fades fastest in UV
· Picking, scratching or slapping the itch

Heal **[3–4] weeks** between sessions. **Next session:** [date]

CALL ME IF

Redness, heat or swelling that spreads after day 3 · pus or red streaks · fever or chills · itchy raised bumps in red ink. Infection signs: see your doctor.

Questions? Text [Phone] [Your Business Name]

Aftercare cards · 4 × 6 in · cut along the dotted lines

AFTERCARE

Touch-up

First week

a shorter, lighter heal

DO

· Wrap off in [2–5] hours, then wash gently
· Fragrance-free soap; pat dry
· Thin ointment [2–3] days, then lotion
· Treat it like a new tattoo until healed

AVOID

· Soaking, pools or hot tubs for [1–2] weeks
· Sun on it; SPF 30+ once healed
· Picking or scratching the flakes
· More work on the area for [4–6] weeks

Heals in about **[1–2] weeks**. Further touch-ups follow my policy. **Next visit:** [date]

CALL ME IF

Redness, heat or swelling that spreads after day 3 · pus or red streaks · fever · rash or hives. Infection signs: see your doctor.

Questions? Text [Phone] [Your Business Name]

AFTERCARE

Second-Skin Healing

Film timeline

[7] days max in total

DO

· Remove first film at [8–24] hours
· Wash gently, pat dry, air-dry fully
· New film on as shown, smooth edges
· Peel off by day [5–6] in a warm shower
· Peel slowly, in the direction of hair

AVOID

· Film on for more than [7] days in total
· Hot tubs, pools or baths with film on
· Re-sticking film that has lifted
· Soaking for [2–4] weeks after film

Fluid or ink under the film is **normal**. After film: lotion. **Next visit:** [date]

CALL ME IF

Rash, itching or blisters at the film edge · fluid leaking out: remove film, wash, text me. Spreading redness, pus or fever: see your doctor.

Questions? Text [Phone] [Your Business Name]

Print this sheet on the back of the card sheets for two-sided cards.

YOUR LOGO

TAKE-HOME CARD

Tattoo Care

Caring for your new tattoo

[Your Business Name]

[Phone] · [Website] · [@handle]

NEXT APPOINTMENT _____

YOUR ARTIST _____

YOUR LOGO

TAKE-HOME CARD

Tattoo Care

Caring for your new tattoo

[Your Business Name]

[Phone] · [Website] · [@handle]

NEXT APPOINTMENT _____

YOUR ARTIST _____